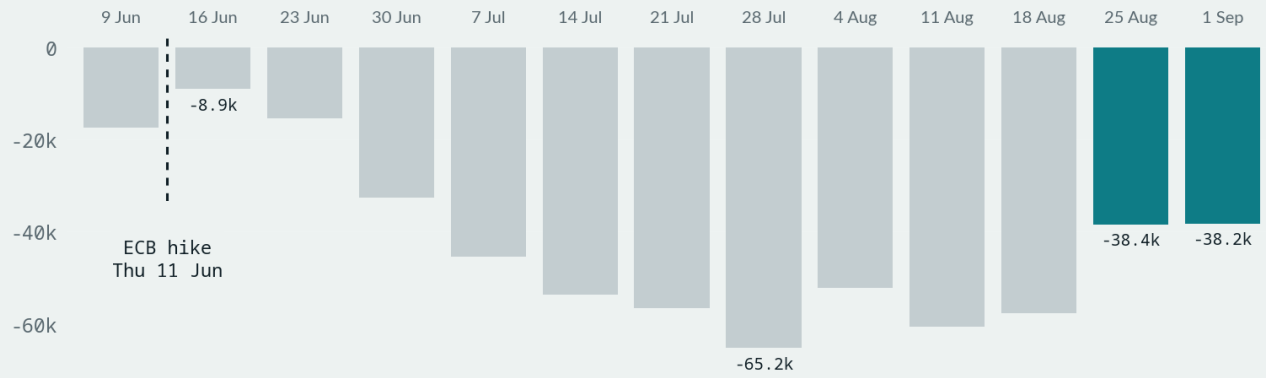
Euro positioning going into the week of 7 September

Leveraged funds in CME euro futures, from the CFTC report released Friday 4 September. Positions are as of Tuesday 1 September, nine days before the ECB decides.

NET, 1 SEP	CHANGE ON THE WEEK	13-WEEK LOW, 28 JUL
-38,173	**+186**	**-65,198**
4.4% of open interest	from -38,359 on 25 Aug	+27,025 contracts since

01 Thirteen weeks of net positioning



Net contracts, leveraged funds, euro FX futures, 9 Jun to 1 Sep 2026. The dashed line marks the ECB's June hike. Highlighted: the last two prints.

Leveraged funds, the category that holds hedge funds and other leveraged accounts, were net short 38,173 euro contracts on 1 September, 4.4% of open interest. That is almost exactly where they stood a week earlier (38,359). That is well off the July extreme: the net short reached 65,198 on 28 July and has since shrunk by 27,025 contracts. Most of that came in the week to 25 August, when funds cut shorts by 18,576, and the position then stalled.

02 Who holds the other side

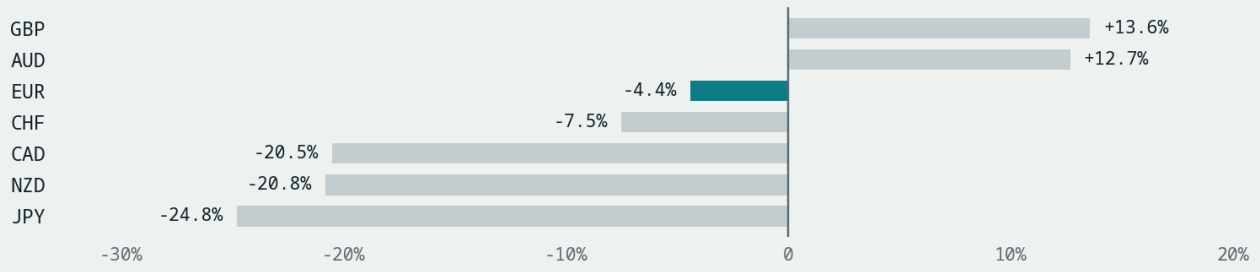
NET POSITION BY CATEGORY	25 AUG	1 SEP	CHANGE	1 SEP, % OF OI
Leveraged funds	-38,359	-38,173	+186	-4.4%
Asset managers	+261,426	+263,253	+1,827	+30.4%
Dealers	-268,581	-267,578	+1,003	-30.9%
Other reportables	+9,602	+8,846	-756	+1.0%
Nonreportables	+35,912	+33,652	-2,260	+3.9%

Net is long minus short outright positions, spreading excluded. Weekly history for 14 weeks and all formulas are in the Excel file.

Asset managers (net long 263,253) and dealers (net short 267,578) hold much larger positions that largely offset each other. Against them, the leveraged funds' net short of 38,173 is small.

03 The other major currencies

Same release, same category. Contract sizes differ, so net as a share of open interest is the fair comparison.



Net as % of open interest, 1 Sep 2026.

LEVERAGED FUNDS, 1 SEP	LONG	SHORT	NET	NET WOW	NET % OI
Euro (EUR)	96,137	134,310	-38,173	+186	-4.4%
British pound (GBP)	77,117	33,950	+43,167	-4,742	+13.6%
Japanese yen (JPY)	58,529	160,717	-102,188	-25,146	-24.8%
Swiss franc (CHF)	12,305	22,603	-10,298	-1,473	-7.5%
Canadian dollar (CAD)	27,845	96,595	-68,750	+3,342	-20.5%
Australian dollar (AUD)	78,498	28,836	+49,662	-4,399	+12.7%
New Zealand dollar (NZD)	5,216	27,554	-22,338	+9,656	-20.8%

WoW is the change from the 25 Aug print. Contract counts are not comparable across currencies.

Funds are far more short the yen (-24.8% of open interest, widened by 25,146 contracts on the week), the New Zealand dollar (-20.8%) and the Canadian dollar (-20.5%). They are net long sterling (+13.6%) and the Australian dollar (+12.7%). The euro's -4.4% is the smallest net short among the five net-short currencies; the Swiss franc, at -7.5%, is next.

04 What this suggests for Thursday

The central bank backdrop published today treats a 25 basis point hike to a 2.50% deposit rate as the base case, which the Bundesbank President said on 2 September markets priced at more than 95%. Positioning does not measure expectations, but it is a cross-check. Funds are not heavily short the euro (4.4% of open interest, against 24.8% for the yen) and the net short has already shrunk by 27,025 contracts from its July extreme. That fits a market not leaning hard against the euro into Thursday's decision. A hike that matches the base case leaves little positioning to unwind, while the surprises the backdrop lists, a hold or a change in guidance wording, would land on a position that is only mildly short. This is context, not a forecast.

LIMIT: positions are as of Tuesday 1 September and were released on Friday 4 September, so they lag by days and miss anything since that Tuesday. Net figures also leave out spreading positions.

THREAD: With policy and positioning set, what does the week's calendar hold? Next: the Monday week-ahead.

SOURCES

1. CFTC, Traders in Financial Futures, Futures Only: EURO FX (code 099741), British pound (096742), Japanese yen (097741), Swiss franc (092741), Canadian dollar (090741), Australian dollar (232741), New Zealand dollar (112741). Positions as of 9 Jun to 1 Sep 2026; latest release used: 4 Sep 2026. Accessed 19 Oct 2026. https://publicreporting.cftc.gov/Commitments-of-Traders/Traders-in-Financial-Futures-Futures-Only/gpe5-46if
2. CFTC, Commitments of Traders, report definitions. Accessed 19 Oct 2026. https://www.cftc.gov/MarketReports/CommitmentsofTraders/index.htm
3. ECB press release of 11 Jun 2026 (June hike on the chart). https://www.ecb.europa.eu/press/pr/date/2026/html/ecb.mp260611~4d41bd5e83.en.html
4. Deutsche Bundesbank, interview with Joachim Nagel in Le Monde, 2 Sep 2026 (market pricing of a September hike). https://www.bundesbank.de/en/press/interviews/-rising-interest-rates-in-the-financial-markets-are-complicating-the-ecb-s-situation--1007256

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